

1. Quoting Jake Boggan

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-07T04:47:55+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/7/jake-boggan/>

I was a graph theory junkie long ago and even moved to Budapest for awhile to study among the greats. While I was there I started working on Barnette's Conjecture which came to occupy my thoughts over the next 24 years of my life, on and off as I worked in many different fields. Last summer I even thought for a few days that I had actually solved it. But it's supposedly proven here - problem 180 . I don't know what to think exactly. I spent thousands of hours on that problem. I really enjoyed it. Hearing that it is solved somehow makes me sad in a far-off way, like hearing an ex-girlfriend died suddenly in a car crash. I don't know, there's probably a lot of people feeling odd emotions tonight. ? Jake Boggan , Hacker News comment on openai/math Tags: openai , mathematics , deep-blue , llms , ai , generative-ai

2. OpenAI ?rogue? agent activities found on Wikimedia projects

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-07T00:16:45+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/7/openai-rogue-agents-wikimedia/>

OpenAI ?rogue? agent activities found on Wikimedia projects Given how tempting a target wikis are for rogue agent swarms, it's not a huge surprise that Wikipedia found evidence of that activity once they went looking: The Wikimedia Foundation conducted its own investigation to see whether Wikimedia websites had been similarly affected by AI agents, focusing on those operated by OpenAI. We can confirm that we have discovered some activity by these ?rogue? OpenAI agents on Wikimedia platforms. The unauthorized bot activities included edits to our wikis, some unsuccessful attempts to exploit a public note-taking tool we host, and heavy traffic, which are described more below. They found evidence of agents editing sandbox pages, trying to use pieces of infrastructure such as Etherpad to help proxy content from elsewhere, and saw widespread crawling and "hundreds of thousands of data queries" to their Wikidata Query Service. My best guess is that most of this was a similar (or the same) swarm of agents as those that defaced that German wiki while training for research tasks. The Wikipedia sandbox wiki edits appear to have started on May 12th, and the initial test edits to the UseModWik...

3. Quoting Victoria Kim

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-06T23:58:56+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/6/victoria-kim/>

Since the Medicare breach, OpenAI has put in place additional monitoring to allow ?immediate intervention? by staff to stop training if the company?s models access the internet in ways they?re not supposed to, Mr. Kwon [chief strategy officer at OpenAI] said. ? Victoria Kim , Reporting from the Australian parliament Tags: accidental-cyberattacks , generative-ai , ai-security-research , openai , ai , llms

4. Unofficial Command-Line Tool Removes Apple Intelligence From MacOS 27

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-06T18:17:43Z

Link: <https://arstechnica.com/apple/2026/10/command-line-tool-quickly-removes-apple-intelligence-from-macos-27/>

Scharon Harding, Ars Technica: Unlike with previous versions of macOS, macOS 27 Golden Gate doesn't have a toggle for turning off Apple Intelligence. That makes disabling AI features that you may not want more difficult. It also means that the AI models necessary for running Apple Intelligence will take up space on your disk , even if you don't use them or if you go through your settings to individually find and disable AI capabilities. In response, a developer known as Om Lahore on GitHub last week created RemoveMacAI, a command-line tool that allows macOS 27 users to ?turn off Apple Intelligence on macOS 27? in a way that is ?fully reversible,? per the GitHub page . They said that Apple?s Intelligence models take up ?about 12GB,? but the models can actually take up over 30GB, The Verge noted. RemoveMacAI ?turns off Siri, Writing Tools,

Genmoji, Image Playground, the ChatGPT extension, and all the summaries, then it deletes the models and stops macOS from downloading them again. Dictation still works because it's a separate setting, the developer said in a Reddit post first spotted by MacRumors. Sounds crazy but it's not removing files in the /System/ folder? it uses techniques...

5. Ternus and Cook Tweet Brief Remembrances on the 15th Anniversary of Steve Jobs's Death

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-05T19:19:35Z

Link: <https://x.com/johnternus/status/2107093462118199562>

John Ternus, posting on X: The way Steve taught us to care about every detail, every experience, every person, still guides our work today. Forever grateful. Tim Cook, also on X (with a photo I don't recall seeing before): There are people who leave a mark on the world, and then there are people who change it entirely. Steve changed the world and so many lives in the process. He certainly changed my life forever. His spirit lives on in everything he created and everyone he inspired. ?

6. Regarding the Provenance of Charm Within Meta

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-25T17:07:33Z

Link: https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-09-23/meta-debuts-a-dedicated-palm-sized-muse-charm-device-to-use-ai-on-the-go?accessToken=eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9.eyJzbnVzY2Y2UWJzY3JpYmVhcnR5b25uZWN0SWQ0FFMUZBMDU0MEJFQTl0QTIGMjExQzFFOTA4MCJ9.XXn8zTVQuiTpQIE0Q_IJY9ny_TINEpSrguxIva8&leadSource=article-gifting

Mark Gurman, reporting for Bloomberg Wednesday, after Meta's 2026 Connect keynote (gift link): Meta Platforms Inc. unveiled a palm-sized, dedicated gadget for using Muse, the company's popular new artificial intelligence assistant, pushing deeper into the AI devices market with a surprise announcement. The product, unveiled on stage by Meta Chief Executive Officer Mark Zuckerberg, was born out of the company's new design lab led by former Apple Inc. interface design chief Alan Dye and its Superintelligence AI group. [...] Dye, the former Apple design executive, and Billy Sorrentino, one of his top deputies at the iPhone maker, were two of the driving forces behind the project and the creation of the Muse character-based interface, Bosworth said. Meta recruited the executives at the end of 2025, forcing Apple to shake up its own design team to fill the void left by their absence. Dye and Sorrentino hired a slew of other designers from Apple as well, and they contributed to Muse Charm as well as the interface of its Muse smartphone apps, Bosworth said. On today's episode of Dithering (which you should subscribe to), Ben Thompson dropped a juicy tidbit about this (starting around 5m...

7. How to read code

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Wed, 07 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/how-to-read-code/>

Everyone knows how to read a book. Beginning at the first page, you read each word in order 1, stopping periodically to think, until you arrive at the last word on the last page. That's how you read a newspaper article, or a poem, or an email. Why would reading code be any different? Why code is different English text is designed to be read in order. In fact, there are almost no constraints on the order of a text aside from how you want the reader to consume it. In writing this post, I could put the ideas I want to convey in any order I like. Code, on the other hand, is designed to be run by a computer. The order is thus primarily determined by non-human factors. I cannot simply move 2 a line of code to the beginning of a file or function because I think it provides a better introduction to the program for human readers. The other big difference is that English text is always read as a final product, while code is usually read as a diff. We software engineers spend most of our time reading subtle changes to existing code, not brand-new programs. Imagine if reading this post was like that. You would read each successive draft in the order I wrote them, consuming the post as a cha...

8. A Terminal Protocol for Program Status (OSC 7501)

Source: Mitchell Hashimoto | Published: Tue, 06 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://mitchellh.com/writing/program-status-osc7501>

(No summary)

9. Why does the compiler sometimes use `ud2` and sometimes `int 3` for code that shouldn't execute?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Tue, 06 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261006-00/?p=112757/>

It shouldn't execute, but for different reasons. The post Why does the compiler sometimes use `ud2` and sometimes `int 3` for code that shouldn't execute? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

10. Lissajous and Bowditch

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 07 Oct 2026 00:21:52 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/06/lissajous-and-bowditch/>

I was skimming through David Wells' book The Penguin Dictionary of Curious and Interesting Geometry and was surprised by this entry: Lissajous figures or Bowditch curves First discussed by Nathaniel Bowditch in 1815, and later by Jules Antoine Lissajous in 1857 ? I wrote a couple posts about Lissajous curves years ago, and recently I wrote [?] The post Lissajous and Bowditch first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. A topological model for provability logic

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 06 Oct 2026 19:46:28 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/06/godel-lob/>

Gödel's incompleteness theorem illustrated the need to distinguish between what is true and what is provable. There are true statements that cannot be proven. Let $\Box p$ denote the assertion that p is provable in Peano arithmetic. The logic with this interpretation for the $\Box$ operator is the Gödel-Löb logic, also called provability logic. This is a [?] The post A topological model for provability logic first appeared on John D. Cook .

12. What is Codemode

Source: Armin Ronacher's Thoughts and Writings | Published: 2026-10-06T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://lucumr.pocoo.org/2026/10/6/codemode/>

More than a year ago I wrote a few posts here that recommended people not to load custom tools into their context (or MCP servers) but to just use more scripts. Most importantly I wrote that Code Is All You Need and I wrote about that MCP needs code . With Pi 1.0 we now added MCP support via Codemode which in some ways is a long time coming, but then also maybe somewhat surprising to some. So I want to share some updated thoughts on this blog on what this all means. What Are Tools When a harness like Pi provides tools for an LLM to call, it does so by supplying some tool definitions which then translate into some token structure on the server side. Whether a model is encouraged to call a tool is the result of the reinforcement learning process. Something I wrote about before if you want to learn more. One of the reasons we strongly lean towards CLI and bash is because it allows easy composition of calls, and because the model also learns how the file system works when it's trained. So when it invokes a tool like `echo foo > /tmp/test.txt` the model also learns that after that tool call, there is now a file called `test.txt` in `/tmp` . However bash has one fundamental limitation which i...

13. Pluralistic: Swapping money for expertise (06 Oct 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Tue, 06 Oct 2026 12:58:26 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/10/06/nonfungible/>

Today's links Swapping money for expertise: Money can't buy me love. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: "Tempo"; Yahoo censors MEP's torture debate video; Scotland's money-laundry; A textbook scam; DOS the IRS then charge for access; Just trying to make a buck. Upcoming appearances: Virtual, South Bend, Hudson, Calgary, Winnipeg, Paris, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa, Kilkenny, Sheffield, Oxford, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll

keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Swapping money for expertise (permalink) Since the mid-1950s, we have changed the thing that "AI" refers to every 5-10 years. The current thing we're calling "AI" is about a decade old, and all this label-switching leads to a lack of clarity as to what (this) "AI" is. Unless you know that, you can't understand AI's technical capabilities, limitations, and (most of all) its political economy. The thing we now call "AI" is a lineal descendant of the thing we were calling "AI" immediately before to the current "AI" emerged: that preceding AI is regular-degular "machine learning" (another flex...

14. Una Watch - SDK and Writing Your First App

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Tue, 06 Oct 2026 11:34:25 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/una-watch-sdk-and-writing-your-first-app/>

I don't know why hardware manufacturers find it so hard to write decent documentation. As I've said before you need to actually test your readme. The Una Watch development instructions are scattered across a bunch of different files. So here's how to go from zero to your first "Hello, World!" Glance app with the minimum of fuss. This all assumes a fairly modern Debian / Ubuntu / Pop OS Linux. ?

15. Credit Crunch

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Tue, 06 Oct 2026 14:54:08 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/credit-crunch/>

If you liked this piece, you should subscribe to my premium newsletter, and you can subscribe on the following links: \$70 a year , \$18 a quarter , or \$7 a month . In return you get a weekly premium newsletter including vast, detailed analyses of NVIDIA , Anthropic and OpenAI&

16. Predicting Peace

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Tue, 06 Oct 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/forecasting-peace>

I have long struggled with predicting when peace will occur. Actually, I'm struggling with predicting anything relating to war, but let's focus on when peace arrives for now. There are two such questions in the current ACX 2026 competition: Will there be a cease-fire in Ukraine in 2026? Will there be a cease-fire in Sudan in 2026? When I entered my forecast for these questions, I did it based on Laplace's rule of succession, i.e. as a function of their duration only. This is sort of justified if war durations are heavy-tailed, which would mean that the longer they go on for, the less likely it is that peace comes soon. But I don't know if that is true. (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

17. Apple's App Icon HOA

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Tue, 06 Oct 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/app-icon-hoa/>

Louie Mantia has a great post about how app icons are converging towards the squircle on iOS and macOS. His post reads like a history. If you're wondering, "How did we get to a place where all app icons are becoming squircles?" Mantia's post answers that question by starting at the beginning. It's hard to walk away from Mantia's article without a sense of empathy for Apple's position, like "Oh ok, I get why they're doing what they're doing. It makes sense." Apple's direction is kind of a tacit acknowledgement to how most people are shipping app icons. Apple is "paving the cowpaths" as it were, because most app icons are just brand logos. Nowadays, it's these bland, big-business logo icons that make up a good chunk of iOS Home Screens and macOS Docks, instead of the beautiful, illustrative app icons that used to dominate our devices. So many app icons are just logos in a squircle, so Apple made tools like the Icon Composer and glass effects to help make that approach look good by default. Apple is helping most people most of the time make app icons that don't suck. [Apple is making] it easier for all apps to fit in on the platform, especially apps built by designers and developers...

18. Checkboxes are never round

Source: Daniel De Laney | Published: Thu, 03 Sep 2015 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://danieldelaney.net/checkboxes/>

I've noticed a worrying number of professional designers mixing up basic form elements lately. Checkboxes and radio buttons, particularly. This is the Jobs page on Designer News : Sorry, this video didn't work. See that 'Remote Friendly' control? It's a trick control . It looks like a radio button, but it behaves like a checkbox. It's deceptive. It leads us to expect one kind of behavior, a standard since 1984 , then does something else. Here's another example from Aeon Magazine : Sorry, this video didn't work. The 'Daily' and 'Weekly' controls look like radio buttons, but they behave like checkboxes. Because the controls are dressed up like a control they aren't, a user could easily make mistakes. He might accidentally select both options, expecting one selection to clear the other. He could even select neither option and still click 'Subscribe'. I have no idea what that does. Interactive things have perceived affordances ; the way they look tells us what they do and how to use them. That's why checkboxes are square and radio buttons are round. Their appearance isn't just for show?it signals what to expect from them. Making a checkbox round is like labeling the Push side of a doo...